

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

Emeryville, CA

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East Bay cyclist and outdoor generalist seeking part-time Bike Sales Floor hours at Sports Basement Berkeley, alongside independent consulting. I help people choose what they will actually use: ask what they need to do, explain it in plain language, and stay until they can do it themselves. Conversational Spanish. Lives in Emeryville; rides as a commute and as a way to meet people. EMT; available weekdays, weekends, and holidays.

Core Competencies

- **Customer conversations:** discovery-style questions, matching a recommendation to real use, and explaining technical details in plain language for beginners and experts
- **Outdoor & cycling:** regular rider (commute and community); skiing; sailing; lives aboard a 1966 sailboat on the SF Bay; AIARE 1 avalanche training; EMT
- **Teaching & follow-through:** walks non-experts through something new until they can do it themselves; steps up without a direct-report title; needs little supervision
- **Communication:** English (native), Spanish (conversational); clear in person and in writing with beginners and non-specialists
- **Safety & physical work:** EMT (2024); comfortable standing a full shift, bending repeatedly, lifting 40 pounds, and working with hands

Professional Experience

- **StaffRoom AI** **Emeryville, CA**
Founder & AI Solutions Consultant *2023–Present*
 - Sell and deliver client work by running discovery first: listen for the job to be done, recommend a path, and stay until they can run it themselves
 - Trained a non-technical operations team to run a new process on their own after cutting their processing time 98%
- **Wiz Music** **Barcelona, Spain**
Community Development Intern *May–Jul 2022*
 - Ran multilingual community operations (English / Spanish / Catalan): diagnosed who was actually showing up versus reported growth, raised it with the team, and ran an artist AMA against the engagement gap
 - Built simple automation so the team spent time with people instead of on repetitive outreach
- **Valhalla Healthcare** **Remote**
Machine Learning Engineer (Intern) *2021*
 - Built a handwritten-clinical-notes ML pipeline into an extensible data model (F1 80.03). Interface work was with a single customer. Python, Keras, TensorFlow, Docker.
- **IBM** **Austin, TX**
Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer *2018–2020*
 - Facilitated Design Thinking sessions to learn what people needed before proposing a solution
 - Wrote release notes and walkthroughs that took non-engineers through a change until they could use it
- **IBM** **Austin, TX**
Research Intern, ThinkLab *2017*
 - Built hands-on VR/AR exhibits (Unity, Kinect, HoloLens) that had to work for a walk-up public audience, not just a specialist

Education

- **University of Colorado Boulder** **Boulder, CO**
B.S. Information Science *2018–2023*
Major GPA 3.7 · Certificate of Cognitive Science · Dean's List (Fall 2019, Spring 2023). Coursework: User-Centered Design, Community-Based Design. Senior capstone: Gamifying Outdoor Education in Software.

Certifications & Outdoor

- **RC Health Services**
Emergency Medical Technician *2024*
- *AIARE 1 Avalanche Safety and Rescue* *2022*
- Regular cyclist (commute and community rides); skier; sailor. Lives aboard a 1966 sailboat on the SF Bay.

Languages

- English (native), Spanish (conversational; two years of university coursework and a multilingual workplace in Barcelona).

Honors and Awards

- **2nd Place, IBM Hackathon for Racial Justice**, Team Lead / Data Scientist (2020): unified a mixed intern team and presented to executive judges.

References

- Available upon request.